

# **1 - Introduction**

-> Voice over of story so far

## **2 - Pirate Raid on Audience**

-> Lots of improv! pirates find booty under audience seats using treasure map

End with Wannabe, Zigazig Arrrrrrrrgh. Yah!

### 3 - The Mermaid's Chest Tavern

-> NEEDS INTRO?

- Graham tries to lift one of two heavy barrels but after a few attempts gives up.

**Graham** : William, could you perhaps help me with these?

- Prawns picks up both barrels easily

**Prawns** : Sure, where do you want them?

**Graham** : Wha...? Oh... Down in the cellar please my boy.

- Prawns carries them offstage cheerfully

**Graham** : That boy has the strength of an ox.

**Frodo** : Who? Prawns? Yes, he's always been a strong lad.

**Graham** : I don't know why you call him Prawns - you should call him "Mussels"! Have you nearly finished clearing up Frodo?

**Frodo** : Almost, just need to clean these glasses.

**Graham** : Very well. I think I shall just rest my eyes a moment, it's been another busy evening and I.....

- He's fallen asleep
- Prawns returns

**Prawns** : Righto Graham, what else do you need... Oh...

**Frodo** : Shhhh... he's asleep. Poor old fella, he's exhausted.

**Prawns** : I think running this tavern is getting too much for him. He needs to think about retiring.

**Frodo** : He'll never do that. Running The Mermaid's Chest is all he has - he'd be lost without it.

- Prawns points at the small chest which Graham is clutching

**Prawns** : Have you ever asked him what's in there, he never seems to let anyone near it.

**Frodo** : He's never told me, and I've never asked. It's none of my business.

**Prawns** : I think we should have a look...

**Frodo** : We can't, it's not right, and anyway, we'd wake him.

**Prawns** : An earthquake wouldn't wake him... Look...

- He begins to prise the chest from Graham's grip

**Frodo** : No Prawns, don't...

**Prawns** : Shhhh! Now then, gently does it... there!

- Graham snores loudly as Prawns releases the chest, he splutters briefly, then continues to sleep

**Frodo** : Prawns! You shouldn't have... I mean it's wrong... We'll get in trouble...

**Prawns** : Don't you want to see what's inside?

**Frodo** : No, I mean, yes... a bit... but...

- Prawns opens the chest and takes out a few bits of paper

**Prawns** : Just some scraps of paper, and this bell

**Frodo** : Careful Prawns, don't ring it... You'll wake him!

**Prawns** : He's fast asleep

- Prawns shakes the bell violently but no sound is heard

**Prawns** : See, I've not woken him. In fact, it didn't even make a noise. What's the point of a bell if it doesn't ring?

**Frodo** : Why would anyone keep a silent bell?

- There is an ominous rumbling followed by a terrifying screeching sound heard from a distance
- Graham stirs, splutters a little and then wakes. He looks at the bell and then looks horrified.

**Graham** : What have you done? You boys. WHAT HAVE YOU DONE?!?

**Frodo** : We didn't... I mean... We...

**Prawns** : We just wondered what was in...

**Graham** : Did you ring "The Silent Bell"????

**Frodo** : No... I mean... Yes, sort of

**Prawns** : But it didn't make any noise

**Graham** : Of course it didn't make a noise. Why do you think it's called the Silent Bell. Oh this is terrible. You two have no idea what you've just done. You have unleashed horrors which you cannot even begin to imagine.

**Prawns** : Have we?

**Frodo** : We didn't mean to unleash any horrors, did we Prawns?

**Prawns** : Oh no, definitely not.

**Graham** : Ringing "The Silent Bell" has awoken "The Kraken"... a most terrifying sea monster. It will slowly rise from the bottom of the ocean, causing storms, chaos and, by the next full moon, the destruction of everything.

**Prawns** : Ooooh 'eck.

**Frodo** : What can we do?

**Graham** : What can you do?! WHAT CAN YOU DO?? Nothing, you've already done more than enough... The Kraken cannot be controlled, unless...

**Frodo** : Unless?

**Graham** : The only way to bring The Kraken under control is to re-unite the Silent Bell with its lost clanger, restoring its power and allowing the holder to command

The Kraken.

**Prawns** : Oh, OK, well let's do that then.

**Graham** : Let's do that then? LET'S DO THAT THEN????!!!! It's impossible. The clanger was deliberately separated from the bell so that they can never be re-united. So that no-one can take control of The Kraken. The Gods made me the keeper of the bell and sent my love far away with the clanger. We were forbidden to ever see each other again, so the bell can never be rung again, and the Kraken can never be controlled again.

**Frodo** : Your "love"?

**Graham** : Stella. Oh my darling Stella, the most beautiful woman you could ever meet. Her hair is like strands of gold, her eyes like deep pools of pure spring water and her chest...

- Frodo and Prawns look a bit embarrassed

**Prawns** : Errrr, yeah, OK, we get the idea...

**Graham** : What, NO! I was about to say that her chest has a pair of hinges which would delight even the most discerning craftsman.

- They look confused

**Graham** : This... This is Stella's chest. The only thing of hers I have left. How I miss her.

**Frodo** : So you've no idea where she is then?

**Graham** : Of COURSE I know where she is. She was banished to Mermaid's Cove, forbidden to step on dry land, while I was banished here, to this tavern, forbidden to enter the sea.

**Prawns** : She's a mermaid?!?

**Graham** : Of COURSE she's a mermaid. Why do you think this tavern is called The Mermaid's Chest? A tribute to my love. The queen, of the mermaids.

**Frodo** : So, you're not allowed to go to sea, and she's not allowed to leave the sea?

**Graham** : These are the curses we face. And now that The Kraken has been disturbed, we are all doomed.

**Frodo** : But nothing stops us going to sea, and nothing stops us finding Stella. Maybe WE could find the clanger and WE could ring the bell and WE could stop The Kraken destroying everything before the next full moon?

**Prawns** : Yeah, doesn't sound too difficult really, does it?

**Graham** : You two? I really don't think that would be a good idea...

**Frodo** : Look, this is our fault, we should put it right. Tell us how to find Stella.

**Graham** : Well, we ARE all doomed unless someone can re-unite the bell and the clanger.

**Prawns** : Exactly... Doomed!

**Graham** : And the only people I know who can help are you two incompetent idiots.

**Prawns** : Exactly... Us two uncompetent idiots! Frodo, what does uncompetent mean.

- Graham retrieves a map from somewhere and unrolls it

**Graham** : Now listen closely, I shall say this only once.

**Prawns** : What did he say?

**Frodo** : Shhh Prawns!

**Graham** : WE are, HERE. Mermaid Cove is HERE on the North East corner of Thomas Cook Island.

**Frodo** : Thomas Cook Island, got it, right. And what's this?

- He points at a small rock in the middle of the sea which has a big red cross drawn on it.

**Graham** : Never, ever, ever go anywhere near there. I cannot stress this enough. This is the home of pure evil, deceit, hatred. You must never visit this place.

**Prawns** : I went to Magaluf last summer, it can't be THAT bad!

**Graham** : I'm serious William. Both of you, promise me you will avoid this despicable location at all costs.

**Frodo** : We promise. Right, we need a ship, and a crew. We're off to save the world from destruction.

- Frodo rolls up the map and starts to leave
- Prawns picks up the bell and follows him

**Prawns** : Don't worry, we won't let you down.

- They leave
- Graham shakes his head sadly

**Graham** : You already have my boys, you already have.

- Curtains close
- FOC

**Prawns** : Did you understand any of that?

**Frodo** : Not really... Mmm, what about you ladies and gentlemen. Did you understand any of that?

**Prawns** : I must admit, I got a bit confused by that map

**Frodo** : Me too. I think we need some help, find someone who's good with maps and stuff.

**Prawns** : Well there's Geeky Oz at the Ship Shop. I mean he's annoying, but he does seem clever.

**Frodo** : He IS annoying, but you're right, he might be able to help. Off to the Ship Shop then.

- They leave

### 3.5 - FOC Royal Navy

***Captain Biggleswade*** : Stop all this uproar, or I shall be forced to begin flogging some of you. Now as I expect you already know, I am Captain Biggleswade of His Majesty's Navy. THIS... is Lieutenant Crump.

***Lieutenant Crump*** : Hiya!

***Captain Biggleswade*** : We've had reports of pirate activity in the area. Has anyone seen a pirate recently?

***Lieutenant Crump*** : Withholding information regarding pirate activity is a serious offence which could result in a fine of 30 shillings...

***Captain Biggleswade*** : Or hanging!

***Lieutenant Crump*** : Hanging sir?

***Captain Biggleswade*** : Or, worse!

***Lieutenant Crump*** : Indeed sir.

***Captain Biggleswade*** : So come on... one of you must know something. Lieutenant Crump, begin taking statements, in case we need to conduct an official Navy investigation.

***Lieutenant Crump*** : From all of them sir? It might take rather a long time.

***Captain Biggleswade*** : Well of course it will take time, Crump... They're building a completely new scene behind these curtains. [To the audience] I should imagine it will be very impressive.

***Lieutenant Crump*** : Name? [He writes it down] And where were you when the pirates arrived? Mmmmm... [writing more] how convenient.

- Once the scene is ready, a seagull "flies" out between the curtains with a message attached to its foot

***Captain Biggleswade*** : Lieutenant... This is a message from Naval Intelligence. The pirate ship has been sighted off the coast, not far from our current position. We must

set off in pursuit.

***Lieutenant Crump*** : Aye aye Captain Biggleswade

***Captain Biggleswade*** : I haven't forgotten how obstructive some of you have been. Rest assured, justice will be served. The Navy never sleeps.

- They leave

## 4 - On The Pirate Ship

**Nobeard** : [To the audience] Arrrrghhh, it's you lot again. Back for more are we? Well this be our ship, The Iron Lady. I'm Captain No-beard, the most fearsome pirate captain across the seven seas. And these are my crew... The Spicy Girls. Please show your appreciation for Sporty Spice.

- Sporty cartwheels on and then does a couple of karate moves

**Sporty** : Yarrrrr!

**Nobeard** : Ginger Spice

- Ginger floats on and then recites...

**Ginger** : I wandered lonely as a cloud, that floats on high o'er wave and crest, when all at once I saw a crowd, a host of ships, heading due West, a flying whale then ate the fleet, and spat them out as pickled meat.

**Nobeard** : Thanks for that, beautiful verse Ginger. Now ladies and gentlemen, please welcome, Scary Spice

- Scary walks on glaring at the audience. She wanders back and forth across the front looking for a "victim"
- Eventually she settles on someone and after staring at them for a moment...

**Scary** : Boooo!

**Nobeard** : Posh Spice

- Posh walks on, gives a peace sign?

**Posh** : Yaaah

**Nobeard** : Now then, Sporty, Ginger, Scary, Posh... where's our other shipmate, which one be she?

- Possible banter with the audience?
- What? "Baby Spice" - A pirate ship's no place for a baby!

**Nobeard** : This... is Old Spice

- Norah hobbles on as an old lady pirate (groaning)

**Norah** : Why do I always have to be an old person?

**Sporty** : Somebody has to play the little old lady.

**Ginger** : And you're very good at it Norah.

**Posh** : Yaaah, rillly good.

**Scary** : Do you think you could be scary?

**Nobeard** : Maybe next year you won't have to play an "old person"?

**Norah** : Hmphhh... How disappointing!

**Nobeard** : Right girls, where's our booty?

- A sack is dragged on stage containing treasure they've nicked

**Nobeard** : This is a poor haul girls. We need to find real treasure.

**Ginger** : Where would we find real treasure captain?

**Norah** : Mermaids!

**Scary** : What?

**Norah** : In the olden days, they'd say Mermaids looked after the best treasure.

**Ginger** : Oh Norah, you are funny.

**Sporty** : Mermaids indeed.

**Posh** : Mermaids don't exist.

**Norah** : They DO exist!

**Nobeard** : Well, where would we find a mermaid today?

**Norah** : There's a tavern we should visit

***Ginger*** : A tavern, how romantic

***Scary*** : I like taverns. Always a chance of a fight...

***Sporty*** : Will there be diet rum?

***Posh*** : Ok, yahhhh, let's go to the tavern.

***Nobeard*** : Right girls, set sail to... The Tavern.

## 5 - Oz's Ship Shop

**Oz** : Right then, let's have a look at this map of yours. Oh yes, it's pretty simple really, I've dealt with much more complicated maps than this in my time. Now then, yes, I see, yes, interesting, yes, the names seem to be in some kind of code, or perhaps a foreign language, no, no I think it must be a code, now then how to decipher it...

**Frodo** : I think you've got it upside down?

**Oz** : What? Upsi... No! No that's how, I mean, I was just assessing the, I mean, that's how you're supposed to begin looking at a map, upside down... that's what you're meant to do.

**Prawns** : Oh, right, we don't really understand maps you see.

**Oz** : Well obviously. Right so now I'm ready to look at it the other way round. Ah, yes, I see, so we're here, Nudii Island is to the West and then just across Dire Strait is, wait, what does this cross mean?

**Frodo** : Oh, I, errr, I'm not sure I can remember. Graham did mention it, but I... Prawns?

**Prawns** : Oh, sorry, no, I'd stopped listening to him.

**Frodo** : I'm pretty sure he said it was very important.

**Oz** : Well of COURSE it's important. Red crosses on maps are always important. Well that's decided then. YOU need to go THERE. Now, let me do some calculations... that will be at least 3 days sailing. You'll need supplies for your whole crew for, let's say a week to be safe. And rum, you'll be needing rum. Now which ship did you say was yours?

- He's looking out across the harbour with a telescope?

**Frodo** : Oh, we don't have a ship.

**Prawns** : Yet...

**Frodo** : Yes, yet. We, erm, we hadn't really got that far...

**Oz** : Well, you're not really going to get that far are you, without a ship.

**Prawns** : Mmmmm, no, that's true.

**Frodo** : I see your point.

- Tim enters

**Tim** : Morning Oz you bally old roister-doister. Oh... I say... You've got customers. I thought I was the only one who ever came in here, ha!

**Frodo** : Oh no, it's Posh Tim.

**Prawns** : Oh 'eck, he's more annoying than Geeky Oz.

**Oz** : Yes, good morning Tim. I was just helping these two gentlemen with a technical enquiry if you don't mind waiting your turn.

**Tim** : Ah, it's erm Cockles and Crabs isn't it. Good to see you chaps. Well, there's no rush, I've just nipped in for tin of boat polish. Daddy wants the yacht looking spick and span for the weekend.

**Frodo** : Do you own a boat Tim?

**Tim** : Well, it's more of a luxury leisure craft really, and it's not strictly mine, but Daddy lets me and my chums use it whenever we like.

**Prawns** : Have you got any "chums" Tim?

**Tim** : What? Ha! Well, I mean no, not really, but you know, it's marvellous for entertaining the ladies, if you catch my drift.

**Frodo** : The ladies Tim?

**Tim** : Well, you know, I haven't actually... that is to say... but, you know, maybe one day, what?

- Oz hands a large tin to Tim

**Oz** : Shall I add it to your father's account Tim?

**Tim** : Would you Oz, that would be marvellous. Right-o, I'd better be off. That yacht isn't going to polish itself, ha! Nice to see you chaps again, you must all join me for cocktails on the deck sometime...

**Prawns** : Not likely

**Frodo** : Prawns! Shhhh... Tim's got a boat.

**Prawns** : I know, he won't stop boasting about it...

**Frodo** : And we need a boat

**Prawns** : Do we? Oh, yes, the map, the cross, sorry, I'd forgotten!

**Frodo** : We'd love to join you Tim. How would "now" sound?

**Tim** : Really? I mean, well, I hadn't any plans. Why the bally heck not?

**Frodo** : Oz, perhaps you'd come too?

**Oz** : I'm not joining you for drinks, I'm tee-total, I don't like fun, and I've a shop to run.

**Frodo** : It doesn't look like your shop is particularly busy, and besides, we could really do with a "map expert".

**Oz** : Expert? Expert, eh? Well if you put it like that, perhaps I could spare some time to share my expertise...

**Frodo** : Great! Lead on Tim, let's see this massive yacht of yours...

- Curtains

-> NAVY?

## 6 - The Pirates visit The Mermaid's Chest

- Pirates in Tavern, are they interested in mermaids, he knows a mermaid, they kidnap him.

-> SOME INTRO STUFF HERE - Pirates causing trouble - Graham getting more and more flustered as he tries to keep the tavern running alone

**Nobeard** : Sounds like you know a lot about, mermaids?

**Graham** : Well, you know, I, I mean, I'm no expert.

- Scary rushes up to him and grabs him by the neck
- She's like an east-end gangster

**Scary** : No "expert"? NO "EXPERT"? Sign outside says "The Mermaid's Chest". There's mermaid "souvenirs" "splashed" over all the walls. You've even got a signed photograph of the world's most famous mermaid... Daryl Hannah! So explain, to me, how... you... are not... a mermaid expert?

**Graham** : Well, I errrm, I dabble.

**Nobeard** : Right girls. Seems to me. Graham here knows about mermaids. So, I reckons we need to bring Graham on board.

**Posh** : Yaaaah, cool!

**Ginger** : Oh, how romantic. Welcoming a man, onboard.

**Sporty** : I'm stronger than a man. Look....

**Scary** : He's toast.

**Norah** : Stop! It is bad luck for a man to be on a ship. This will not end well.

**Nobeard** : Well, as a modern leader, I've considered all your opinions, and I'm inclined to... Kidnap Graham!!!!

- They grab Graham and do all sorts of humiliating stuff to him
- They drag him off

- The Navy arrive

***Captain Biggleswade*** : So this is The Mermaid's Chest is it Crump?

***Lieutenant Crump*** : That's correct sir. We had word from one of our spies. They said it was full of pirates.

***Captain Biggleswade*** : Well it doesn't look very full to me. [To the audience] Have you seen any pirates here?

***Lieutenant Crump*** : Sir, over here. Evidence of pirate activity.

***Captain Biggleswade*** : What is it Crump?

***Lieutenant Crump*** : A parrot sir. Almost certainly belongs to a pirate. Shall I interrogate it sir?

***Captain Biggleswade*** : Interrogate it? It looks dead to me.

***Lieutenant Crump*** : I think it might be resting sir. Looks like a Norwegian Blue... Beautiful plumage.

***Captain Biggleswade*** : The plumage don't enter into it. It's gone to meet its maker.

***Lieutenant Crump*** : Perhaps it's just pining for the fjords?

***Captain Biggleswade*** : Pining for the fjords? It's bereft of life. It's joined the choir eternal. This, Crump, is an ex-parrot!

- A boy walks in and starts sweeping up

***Captain Biggleswade*** : You... who are you?

***Boy*** : Boy

***Captain Biggleswade*** : Boy, eh? And you work here do you?

***Boy*** : Well I'm not doing this for the good of my health.

***Lieutenant Crump*** : Don't be so insolent - this is Captain Biggleswade of His Majesty's Navy. Show some respect.

**Captain Biggleswade** : Thank you Crump. Now then "Boy", have you seen any pirates here recently?

**Boy** : Yeah, they just left. You missed them, ran out the back. Never paid for their grog. Took Graham too.

**Captain Biggleswade** : Graham?

**Lieutenant Crump** : The proprietor of this tavern sir. That's him on the wall.

**Captain Biggleswade** : Mmmm, strange looking fellow. Very fishy looking.

**Lieutenant Crump** : No, the picture next to the fish sir.

**Captain Biggleswade** : Ah, I see, yes. Graham eh? And which way did they go Boy?

**Boy** : They headed off towards Thomas Cook Island.

**Captain Biggleswade** : Did they by George? Very well, Crump... Recruit this young lad into the Navy.

**Boy** : I don't want to be in the Navy. I get seasick in the bath.

**Captain Biggleswade** : Nonsense. Everyone dreams of joining the Navy. The adventure, the camaraderie, the lovely uniforms. And besides, you're the only one who can identify these pirates, you know how to handle a broom... And you have remarkably clean ears.

- Crump grabs his shoulder

**Boy** : Oi, hands off. I'm not joining the Navy.

**Lieutenant Crump** : I'm afraid you have no choice Boy. The King himself has granted us the right to pressgang anyone we see fit. You're in the Navy now, whether you like it or not.

- Curtains close with the three of them in front

**Captain Biggleswade** : That's right - we want you as a new recruit.

SONG: IN THE NAVY? (FOC)

## 7 - Sailing Tim's Dad's Yacht

**Tim** : I'm not really supposed to be out of the harbour chaps. Daddy doesn't really trust me to actually sail her you see. We really do need to get back before supper time.

**Frodo** : Don't worry Tim, everything will be fine. Oz, which way are we heading?

**Oz** : Well our current bearing is 72.3 degrees South-South-West. We're proceeding at a speed of 12 knots. This is really quite a fast vessel, we should reach our destination sooner than I predicted. Your friend seems to be handling the mainsail with the strength of an entire crew.

**Prawns** : I don't know what I'm doing, but I can pull on a rope if you ask me to.

- There is the sound of a female voice singing over the noise of the waves

**Tim** : I say, can you hear that chaps?

**Oz** : It's beautiful

**Prawns** : Lovely

**Frodo** : Enchanting

**Tim** : Perhaps I can finally invite a lady on board

**Prawns** : I can see something, off to the right

**Oz** : It's starboard. You can see something off starboard.

**Prawns** : Oh, right, sorry. I can see something off "Star Wars".

**Frodo** : It's a woman, tied to a buoy.

**Tim** : I say!

**Frodo** : Not a boy, a buoy.

**Prawns** : She's got a lovely singing voice, I think we should go closer.

**Oz** : So do I

**Frodo** : Me too, for some strange reason.

**Tim** : Ahoy there madam. My name's Tim. Would you care to join me for cocktails?

- The lights illuminate Jean, a wild witch-like siren. She stops singing.

**Jean** : Ah, four handsome sailors entranced by my song.

**Frodo** : Are you alright? You appear to be chained up.

**Jean** : That I am, that I am. You're probably asking yourselves, who would do this to such a beautiful woman?

**Prawns** : I wouldn't have gone that far.

**Frodo** : Prawns! Shhh. Madam, we are on a quest, Oz show her the map. We are looking for Stella... Are you Stella?

**Jean** : Stella?! Stella you say? Now there's a name I haven't heard in a long time.

**Prawns** : Is that you? Are you called Stella?

**Jean** : No, I do not go by THAT name.

**Oz** : Right, well, this must be the wrong place, come on, let's head back to harbour.

- Jean sings a bit more
- Tim has been pouring a cocktail

**Tim** : That's not very chivalrous old man. We can't leave a damsel in distress.

**Frodo** : Do you know Stella?

**Jean** : Oh, I know Stella. She and I go back a long way. A long, long way. Oh yes, Stella and I know each other very well indeed... ha ha ha!

**Prawns** : I think she might know Stella

**Oz** : [Sarcastically] What gives you that impression?

- Jean sings a bit more

**Jean** : If you rescue me, I can help you find Stella. I can take you to her. I know where Stella is.

**Prawns** : I think she might know where Stella is.

**Oz** : [Losing patience] I know! She said!!!

**Frodo** : Madam, we shall help you. Prawns, can you break that chain?

- Jean sings a bit more
- Prawns reaches down and snaps the chain

**Prawns** : Not a problem. To be fair, it had gone a bit rusty.

- They help Jean onto the yacht
- Tim offers her a cocktail

**Tim** : It's my pleasure to welcome such a, errr, charming lady onboard. This is The Smooth Operator, and I'm her captain, Tim.

**Prawns** : I'm William, but everyone calls me Prawns

**Oz** : I'm Oz, the map expert.

**Frodo** : And I'm Frodo. I'm sorry, I'm not sure we caught your name.

**Jean** : I go by many names. Siren of the Seas, The Temptress of The Deep, Destroyer of Ships... but you can call me Jean.

- They all look at each other, slightly alarmed and confused, then mutter awkwardly, "nice to meet you Jean" etc

**Jean** : And what business do you have with my old friend Stella.

**Frodo** : We've been sent on a quest to find the clanger for this bell. You see, HE rang it and awoke The Kraken and we need to re-unite the bell and the clanger so we can ring it again and then we can control The Kraken but we have to do it before the next full moon, or we're all doomed.

**Jean** : Oh, ha, ha, ha! What a delightful story. You almost sound like you believe it... (to audience) These fools have no idea what they've just done. I will let them take me to Stella, I will use them to get the clanger, and I will use the bell to gain command of The Kraken once more. Then I shall have revenge upon Stella, Graham, and everyone else who allowed me to rot in the middle of the ocean. (Back to crew) Well, I cannot promise you'll control this "Kraken" of yours, but I will take you to Stella. You... "map expert", plot a course to Thomas Cook Island. You, pull the jib, hoist the mainsail and do whatever you're supposed to do with a spinnaker. And you... pour me another of these delicious pina coladas.

## 8 - Arrival at Thomas Cook Island

FOC

**Vernon** : Right, so Jess is it? Well welcome to the dream team. Who did you work for previously?

**Jess** : First Choice

**Vernon** : Mmmmm, well I'm not being funny but we're a bit more "Last Choice" here if you know what I mean. We've not had any guests for months, so you'll have to think on your feet if anyone does turn up. You do know we're "commission only" here?

**Jess** : They didn't say anything about that at the interview...

**Vernon** : Oh, that's HR for you, they've no idea what it's like on the front line. Well as I'm sure you know, we're very much people people here on Thomas Cook Island. Customer satisfaction is paramount. We want to make our guests feel at home, we want them to have an unforgettable holiday... and we want to squeeze every last penny out of them...

**Jess** : I'm sorry, what was the last bit?

**Vernon** : Upsell, upsell, upsell Jess. If there's a trip they haven't booked, if there's an activity they haven't paid for, if there's a chance they might donate to one of our local charities, it's our job to get their cash.

**Jess** : We work with local charities?

**Vernon** : Of course not Jess, it's just a thing we say... "Oh come and visit the hedgehog sanctuary and help save the little darlings". Thomas Cook Island is facing financial ruin Jess, we have to do what we have to do.

**Jess** : Oh. I see. Well I didn't realise when.....

**Vernon** : Shhhhh Jess... I can hear voices.

- Curtains open

**Prawns** : I still don't understand why Jean isn't with us.

**Oz** : Because Prawns, she said she wanted to give Stella a lovely surprise.

**Frodo** : So she told us exactly where we'll find her

**Oz** : Then we'll bring her back to the ship and have a reunion party, not that I agree with parties

**Tim** : I can make more cocktails, I'm really starting to enjoy entertaining glamorous ladies

- Everyone else looks at him quizzically

**Vernon** : Welcome holidaymakers, welcome to Thomas Cook Island. My name's Vernon, and I'm head of fun here. This is Jess and she... I'm sorry... JESS, can you start handing out the welcome drinks please... Jess has only just joined us, still learning the ropes... Thank you Jess, quick as you like... oooh, honestly. Where was I, oh yes, so if I can just take your names, tick you off... You are?

**Prawns** : Prawns!

**Vernon** : Sorry? Prawns? Are you sure... you're not on my list.

**Prawns** : Oh, maybe William? That's my real name...

**Vernon** : No there's no William here either. Did you book through a travel agency? Was it LastMinute, cos they're rubbish they are. Always leaving things until the la... well, you know...

**Frodo** : We haven't "booked" at all. We're on a quest to find Stella, in Mermaid Cove.

**Vernon** : Oh, I see, no booking... well, let me think... Oooh, well you might be in luck, you see we've had a late cancellation. We may just be able to squeeze you in.

**Jess** : I thought you said we hadn't had any guests in weeks?

**Vernon** : Shut up Jess... I'm sorry, she's new. We've had lots of guests, we're almost fully booked, but I can offer you a room for four in our presidential suite.

**Jess** : Do we have a presidential suite Vernon? It's not on my...

**Vernon** : Be quiet Jess, of course we do. Now you're "all inclusive" which means you can eat as much as you like, and all your local drinks are free, that's your Carling, your John Smiths and your B&Q White Spirit but I'm afraid you DO have to pay for the good stuff. Now are any of you interested in watersports? No? No-one? Shame.

**Frodo** : We just want to go to Mermaid Cove.

**Vernon** : Oh, Mermaid Cove? You want to go to Mermaid Cove do you? Mermaid Cove indeed!

**Prawns** : Yes, we need to get to Mermaid Cove.

**Jess** : There's a trip to Mermaid Cove tomorrow.

**Vernon** : Is there? I mean, yes, of course there is... We can book you on the Mermaid Cove tour. Jess, Jess, fetch the book. Now, we've got some high-class entertainment on tonight. No, not me, thanks for asking... Take a seat, enjoy your welcome drinks and allow me to introduce, tonight's cabaret act. By day, he looks after the gardens here at the resort, mowing the lawns, trimming the hedges, scraping the algae off the pool. BUT... by night he thrills us with his lovely singing voice. Some call him The King... We call him Keith!

- Elvis sings something

## 9 - Bad Luck on The Iron Lady

-> More Yarrrrrs -> More "Bad things"

**Sparty** : The sea's getting choppy Captain, Yarrrrrrr!

**Ginger** : I don't like the look of that sky. It is dark and brooding, like the depths of my soul, since I haven't heard from my sweetheart in weeks. O Romeo, Romeo wherefore art thou Romeo? Art thou a man or just a jellyfish? Thy love doth drift like seaweed in the mist! Yarrrrrrr!

**Scary** : Snap out of it ye weeping wench and secure the main hatch - there's a storm a brewin', Yarrrrr!

**Graham** : Don't you understand. This is what I've been telling you. The Kraken has been awoken. All of this is being caused by The Kraken...

- Posh walks on covered in seagull poo

**Posh** : Those horrible birds. They attacked me. Like in that film, with all the birds, and they attacked that woman. The film, with the birds, what was it called? With all the birds?

- Everyone else looks at her and shrugs

**Posh** : Anyway, they've ruined my new jacket, yahhhh?

**Sparty** : That IS bad luck.

**Norah** : I warned you - it's bad luck to bring a man on board. Last time we had a man on the Iron Lady, she sank.

**Nobeard** : What, are you sure?

**Norah** : I think so... It was a long time ago.

**Nobeard** : Right, well, that's decided then. We can't have a man onboard. Yarrrrrrr!

**Scary** : Yarrrr. So we makes 'im walk the plank eh?

**Ginger** : We can't do that.

**Scary** : Why not?

**Ginger** : We don't HAVE a plank.

**Graham** : What sort of pirates don't have a plank?

- They all turn and stare angrily at Graham

**Scary** : Then we hoists him from the crows nest... by his neck.

**Posh** : But how do we find the treasure? We need him to show us the treasure yahhh?

**Nobeard** : Girls, girls, calm down. We're not going to hang him and we're not going to make him walk the plank. We're going to make him wear these...

- She holds up a large dress and wig

**Nobeard** : It's not bad luck to have a "pretty lady" on board, is it Norah?

**Norah** : Mmmm, suppose not.

**Nobeard** : Right then. Off you go, below deck, quick as you can... before I let her hoist you by the midships.

- Graham shuffles off with the dress and wig

**Sporty** : Captain. There's something in the water.

**Nobeard** : Looks like a bottle.

**Sporty** : I'll grab a net.

**Posh** : Who's Annette, and why haven't we been introduced?

- Sporty rushes back in with a fishing net
- She looks exasperated and points at her net

**Sporty** : A NET...

**Posh** : Oh, yaaaah, I see now, yah!

- They fish the bottle from the sea

**Sporty** : It's another one of those messages.

**Nobeard** : It'll be for Ginger

**Posh** : From her "boyfriend"!

**Scary** : Yarrrr, maybe I could hang HIM from the crows-nest?

**Ginger** : Don't you dare. I'd simply die without receiving his beautiful letters. Give that to me. I sent him a poem, I expect this is his response.

- She pulls the cork from the bottle and unfurls the paper from inside

**Nobeard** : What's it say Ginger?

**Ginger** : My dearest Ginger. "Dearest", he called me "dearest".

**Sporty** : He probably means "weirdest".

**Ginger** : How dare you. My dearest Ginger. Your poem was the most beautiful thing I have ever read, it lit up my day and warmed me up at night. It is surely the best poem every written.

**Nobeard** : He's not much of a poetry expert, is he?

**Ginger** : I wish I could write such wonderful verse, but I ain't got no talent for that kind of stuff.

**Posh** : Clearly!

**Ginger** : But I have exciting news. Me and Prawns have been sent on a quest to find the silent bell's clanger. We've met some new friends and we're now at sea, on a boat, with a map. We've met a nice lady called Jean who has agreed to help us. We're on our way to Mermaid Cove. I will write again when our quest is complete. Yours, sinserly. Frodo.

- Graham walks in wearing a dress, wig and make up?

**Graham** : What was that you were just reading? I'm sure I heard you say the name Frodo?

**Nobeard** : Oh, don't you look pretty? See Norah, no more men on board, so no more bad luck.

**Sporty** : That wig suits you actually.

**Posh** : Yahhh, I think that could be next season's "new look".

**Graham** : Never mind that, what were you reading?

- He snatches the letter from Ginger

**Scary** : You give that back to my friend... Or I'll slit yer throat.

- Graham ignores her

**Graham** : Blah, blah, Quest, blah, blah, New Friends, blah, blah... Jean! Oh no. Oh NO NO NO!

**Ginger** : What is it?

**Graham** : This is terrible news. They've found Jean. She's enraptured them. She'll make them do exactly what she wants. You see... you see? This proves what I've been telling you. The bad things that are happening. They're not because you have a man on board. It's The Kraken... and if Jean has been rescued, she'll try to control The Kraken. And the bad things will get much, much worse. You have to take me to Thomas Cook Island. You have to help me, or we'll all be doomed.

- He thrusts the letter back into Ginger's grasp
- She begins to re-read, and looks fearful and desperate

**Sporty** : You don't tell us what to do. We've already got a captain.

**Posh** : Yahhhh, that's right.

**Scary** : I should have your guts for garters

**Nobeard** : Indeed. I'm the Captain of The Iron Lady, and I'm "not for turning".

**Norah** : I think, we should.

***Nobeard*** : What? You think we should help him? Why? You don't believe this Kraken nonsense do you.

***Norah*** : Well... There were stories, when I was a little girl... about... The Kraken!

***Ginger*** : I agree. We must help. What if they're in danger. What if I lose my Frodo? My "dearest".

***Graham*** : Captain, I urge you. We're all in danger unless we stop Jean, and deal with The Kraken. Every ship will be smashed to pieces. All treasure will be lost.

***Nobeard*** : Mmmm. Well I suppose The Iron Lady could be for turning... But if you're lying...

***Scary*** : I'll cut off both your legs. And then make you walk the plank!

## 10 - Trip to Mermaid Cove

- FOC, Jess and Vernon are addressing the coach party

**Jess** : Ok, everyone, we're nearly at Mermaid Cove. The coach will drop you off in the parking area, and it's just a short walk down to the beach.

**Vernon** : You should all have vouchers for the complimentary drinks you paid for - it's either a White Spirit or a fruit juice of your choice... as long as it's orange.

**Jess** : The mermaids will be performing for about 30 minutes and then we'll all meet back here for the trip back to "Last Resort".

**Vernon** : So off you go... Enjoy Mermaid Cove.

- They leave down the aisle

**Jess** : Sir... Are you sure you don't want to leave your big net on the minibus? Sir? Sir!

- Curtains open

**Prawns** : Right lads, who fancies a swig of white spirit.

**Oz** : You shouldn't drink that without safety glasses. It says so on the label.

**Tim** : Why did we leave Jean alone on my boat?

**Oz** : It's not YOUR boat Tim.

**Tim** : Why did we leave Jean alone on Daddy's boat?

**Frodo** : Because she told us to. She said we had to come and find the mermaid.

**Prawns** : She's very persuasive. Whenever she sings, it feels like I'd do anything she asks.

**Tim** : It's like she has us under a spell...

- There's an announcement

"And now, Mermaid Cove is proud to present... The Little Mermaids"

- Little Mermaids dance to the musical introduction
- Then Stella appears and sings her song

**Stella** : My name's Stella, the queen of the mermaids and it's my pleasure to perform for you this evening. Now then, let's have a look at you. Oh, we've got a lovely audience in tonight.

-> Maybe more audience interaction/banter/jokes here?

**Prawns** : [To Oz] It's Stella, the one we're looking for. This is Stella!!!

**Oz** : I know. She said.

**Frodo** : I thought Graham said she was the most beautiful woman in the world?

**Prawns** : What? Oh, yes, he did say something like that.

**Frodo** : He said she had hair like strands of gold.

**Tim** : Does your friend Graham have a problem with his eyesight?

**Frodo** : He said her eyes were like pools of clear blue water.

**Oz** : I think he should have gone to Specsavers.

**Prawns** : He was right about her chest though. Lovely craftsmanship.

- They all look at him, confused.

**Frodo** : Well, if this is Stella, we have to capture her. That's what Jean wanted.

**Prawns** : I'm not going anywhere near her. Her breath smells of seaweed.

**Frodo** : Oz, Tim, you distract her... we'll get the net.

- Oz and Tim shuffle awkwardly into Stella's proximity

**Stella** : Oh, and look at these attractive young men. I'm Stella... what's your name handsome?

**Tim** : Ah, gosh, erm... Tim.

**Stella** : Tim... What an exotic name. I bet you've got all the girls lusting after you Tim?

**Tim** : Oh, I, errr, I mean, not really, but you know....

**Stella** : And who's this Tim. Is this one of your friends.

**Oz** : No actually. Tim and I are NOT friends. We are simply co-conspirators in somebody else's quest, the aim of which is, One... to retrieve the missing clanger from a bell which has supernatural powers, and Two... to kidnap a mermaid named Stella.

**Stella** : A mermaid, named Stella? But I'm a mermaid. And my name's...

**Frodo** : Now Prawns, the net...

- Prawns throws the net over Stella and she begins flapping wildly

**Stella** : Oi, what are you doing you scumbags. Let me go. What's going on. Why am I in this net. You can't do this. I'm Queen Of The Mermaids!!!

- Lights and Curtains

## FOC - Navy Guys Interview Vernon and Jess

- They've reported 4 missing guests
- Navy are keen to establish if they are the pirates

**Lieutenant Crump** : And you say these four guests never returned to the minibus?

**Jess** : That's correct. We've done a headcount 3 times, they're definitely missing.

**Lieutenant Crump** : We don't usually get involved in missing persons cases. We're The Royal Navy you see. But on this occasion....

**Captain Biggleswade** : What did they look like. Were they a bit piratey?

**Vernon** : A bit "piratey"?

**Captain Biggleswade** : Eyepatches, parrots, wooden legs, golden earrings, skulls, crossbones... Did they say "me hearties" a lot?

**Jess** : "Me hearties"? I don't think so, no.

**Captain Biggleswade** : Are you sure now. We're in pursuit of pirates you see. Any information you can provide could help us to apprehend these scoundrels of the oceans.

**Vernon** : One of them had a big net.

**Lieutenant Crump** : [Making notes] So we're looking for a group of possible pirates accompanied by a big girl called Annette.

**Jess** : And one of the mermaids has gone missing.

**Captain Biggleswade** : Was she called Annette?

**Jess** : No... Stella.

**Boy** : That was the mermaid Graham was always droning on about.

**Lieutenant Crump** : Quiet Boy. We don't pay you to show off to civilians.

**Boy** : You don't pay me at all.

**Lieutenant Crump** : I'm warning you, one more word and you will be thrown out of the Navy.

**Boy** : Good. Can I go home then?

**Captain Biggleswade** : Ha! That's the spirit Boy. Right then. We need to find this Stella.

- The Navy disappear through the curtains
- Vernon shouts after them

**Vernon** : I'm sorry, we've only got Carling or John Smiths!

- Jess and Vernon disappear through the curtains

## 11 - Jean and Stella

**Jean** : Oh Stella, what a delight to see you again. I hope you don't mind if I keep you in the net, but I don't want you wriggling your way out of this. Now, what's this you're wearing round your neck.

- She pulls at the cord round Stella's neck
- The clanger falls to the deck

**Jean** : Oh Stella... it looks like you've dropped a clanger.

**Stella** : You'll never get away with this Jean

**Jean** : I've already got away with it. I have the bell. Now I have the clanger. I have a ship and we're heading to Nudii bay. Once I'm there I will re-unite the bell and the clanger and I shall take control of The Kraken. Then I shall take control of... everything!

## 12 - The Fellowship Regret Their Actions

**Prawns** : My head hurts, I can't remember what happened last night.

**Tim** : I feel like I've been mesmerised by a mesmerising machine

**Frodo** : We were supposed to be looking for Stella

**Oz** : I think we found her

**Prawns** : Did we?

**Tim** : Where is she?

**Frodo** : We took her back to the boat

**Oz** : We left her with Jean

- Graham storms in to the bar

**Graham** : What, is the meaning of this?

**Frodo** : Graham! What are you doing here?

**Graham** : Never mind that. Why are you all lounging around like drunken sailors? You're supposed to be on a quest. Where is the bell?

**Frodo** : On the boat

**Graham** : And where is The Clanger?

**Frodo** : With Stella

**Graham** : And where is Stella

**Prawns** : On the boat

**Graham** : And where is the boat?

**Tim** : In the harbour, over th... oh, she's gone

**Oz** : Jean must have taken her

**Graham** : Jean?? JEAN!!! You've given the boat to Jean

- They all nod

**Graham** : And you've given the bell to Jean

- They nod again

**Graham** : And you've given the clanger to Jean?

- They nod again

**Graham** : And Stella? You've taken Stella to Jean?

- They nod again

**Graham** : You sailed to the exact place I told you to avoid at all costs. You set Jean free. Then you took Jean on board your ship. Then you handed everything over to Jean, including the woman I love. Now, Jean has all she needs. Soon she will control the Kraken. Then, she will cause chaos on the seas.

**Nobeard** : Cause chaos on the seas? That's our job. Me and my girls cause chaos on the seas. I'm not having this Jean taking over... who does she think she is?

**Ginger** : Yarrrr, who does she think she is?

**Posh** : Yahh, who is she?

**Nobeard** : We're going to find this Jean, and we're going to show her who the real chaos queens are.

SONG: Who Do You Think You Are?

## 13 - The Kraken is summoned in Nudii Bay

**Jean** : This is it, we're here, in Nudii Bay. The bell and the clanger are together again. All that I need to do now is ring the bell, and I shall control the awesome power of The Kraken.

**Stella** : Don't do it Jean, for heaven's sake, you know what happened last time you dabbled with the power of the Kraken.

**Jean** : Oh I remember Stella, I remember all too well. I caused chaos and misery. I destroyed your happiness... and I destroyed... Graham!

**Stella** : But you destroyed your own life too Jean. You were marooned in the middle of the sea, alone and miserable. Nobody won Jean, nobody won...

**Jean** : You're wrong Stella. I won, because you two lost. You were separated forever. The thought of you two being alone and miserable made my loneliness and misery worth every moment.

**Stella** : Oh Jean, what have you become. You were a good looking woman, not as good looking as me, but still... passable. And you were always good with numbers, you could have made it as an accountant, or perhaps worked in a bank. You could have had it all Jean, but you threw it away by summoning The Kraken, unleashing armageddon. The Gods were never going to let you get away with it.

**Jean** : Silence Stella. I've heard enough of your pathetic whimpering. I shall summon The Kraken, again...

- She rings the bell
- A terrible roar is heard

**Stella** : You could have been an accountant Jean... you could have been an accountant.... sob...

**Jean** : There... over to the left, I see it... The Kraken. I shall test its power...

**Stella** : It's PORT Jean, not "the left"... it's called PORT!!! sob.

**Jean** : Kraken... I command you... unleash your fire-breath on Nudii Island!!

- There is a loud roar and a burst of orange light
- Offstage we hear

"Flippin 'eck Dorothy... where did that fireball come from?"

"Ooooo, I think it was that big octopus thingy in the bay. I've never seen that before"

"Oooooooh... my sausage is on fire"

"Well I told you not to stand so close the barbecue Ken, it's hot"

**Jean** : Ha! That'll teach those weirdos. I've always hated Nudii Island. All those old people walking around with no clothes on.

**Stella** : Oh Jean, what a bitter woman you've become.

"Ooooo, Ken, that fireball's toasted my baps"

"Flippin' octopus, with it's flippin' fireballs. I told you we shouldn't have retired here. We had a perfectly nice bungalow in Langley"

"Langley was boring Ken..."

- Curtains

## 14 - FOC Pirate Battle Plan

**Nobeard** : Right you bunch of pathetic powder monkeys. Who here thinks they're fit to fight for freedom. Which of you can fire a canonball from the Iron Lady's broadsides?

**Ginger** : There you go madam, careful not to shoot backwards

**Scary** : You look a likely lad. Think you can hit a ship from 50 yards?

- Curtains

**Nobeard** : Hold your nerve, steady now, nobody fire until I gives the order.

- Jean's turns her yacht slowly towards the audience

**Nobeard** : Now.. Fire.. Fire..

- The yacht takes a hit and begins to sink

**Graham** : Stella, be careful, Stella is on board that ship.

- The yacht disappears beneath the surface
- Stella emerges from the waves, clutching the bell

**Stella** : I've got it Graham, I've saved the bell

**Graham** : Oh Stella. You see boys, not only is she was the most beautiful woman in the world... but she's brave too.

**Narrator** : And so Stella and Graham were re-united and the bell was rescued. Graham rang the bell and commanded the Kraken to return to the bottom of Nudii Bay. Jean was lost, presumably drowned. Frodo and Ginger married in a traditional pirate wedding

## **15 - Finale**

Jean swims to shore where she is met by Nudii Islanders Nudii residents are OAPs and deaf Welcome to Nudii Island... Let's get you out of those wet clothes.